

Fire Ant Sting - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1182 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Qatar-localized UAT-only adult and pediatric pathway for suspected fire-ant stings, screening for anaphylaxis, multiple-sting toxicity, infection and high-risk patients; species-specific Qatar governance is required before production.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [LOCATION] Where was the caller stung?
2. [OPEN_TEXT] How many stings?
3. [YES_NO] Any prior serious allergic reaction to insect stings?
4. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the exact age; is the patient pregnant; how many stings and where; and are there breathing/swallowing symptoms, vomiting, dizziness, widespread rash, fever, severe pain, immune suppression or safeguarding concerns?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Anaphylaxis

Are throat or tongue swelling, breathing difficulty, faintness, confusion, or collapse the main concern?

Systemic allergic-reaction features require the Anaphylaxis pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Are the lips, mouth, throat, or tongue suddenly swollen, is the person struggling to breathe, or has anyone lost consciousness or become floppy?

NHS.UK insect bites and stings guidance lists these as signs of a serious allergic reaction (anaphylaxis) - use an adrenaline auto-injector immediately if available.

1. Disposition level 70

Are there multiple stings, symptoms worsening, or a previous serious allergic reaction to a sting?

NHS.UK guidance lists multiple stings and a prior serious reaction as reasons for an urgent clinical review.

1. Disposition level 70

After emergency features are excluded, is any fire-ant sting suspected, including a single or few local stings?

Species and cumulative venom risk cannot be confirmed remotely; this Qatar UAT pathway requires prompt clinical assessment rather than medication-led self-care.

Advice

Emergency allergic reaction precautions

- Call Qatar 999 immediately and follow dispatcher instructions. If the patient has their own prescribed adrenaline auto-injector, use it according to its plan. Keep the patient lying down unless breathing is difficult; do not let them stand or walk and do not drive. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: symptoms persist or recur; loss of consciousness.

Urgent sting review

- Apply a cold compress and arrange same-day medical review, especially with multiple stings or a prior reaction history.
- Call Back If: swelling spreads; breathing becomes difficult.

Prompt assessment for local ant stings

- Move away from further exposure, gently wash the area, avoid squeezing pustules or applying unverified products, and arrange prompt review through the Qatar pathway approved for UAT. Medication requires age, weight, pregnancy, allergy, comorbidity and interaction checks.
- Call Back If: swelling worsens; systemic allergy or infection develops.

First aid

- Call Qatar 999 immediately and follow dispatcher instructions. If the patient has their own prescribed adrenaline auto-injector, use it according to its plan. Keep the patient lying down unless breathing is difficult; do not let them stand or walk and do not drive. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Insect bites and stings", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/insect-bites-and-stings/> (page last reviewed 01 June 2023)

Provenance

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